

Atlantic herring

Clupea harengus

- ↔ Up to 18 in (46 cm)
- 📍 North Atlantic, North Sea, Baltic Sea
- ⊗ Locally common

A typical open-ocean schooling fish, the Atlantic herring's behavior of gathering into large groups to

confuse predators also makes it an important species in commercial fisheries. Other schooling members of the herring family, such as sardines, form some of the biggest aggregations of fish on the planet. Herrings spawn in schools too, laying adhesive eggs that form a thick mat on the seabed.



Common carp

Cyprinus carpio

- ↔ Up to 4 ft (1.2 m)
- 📍 W. Europe to SE. Asia
- ⊗ Vulnerable

The deep-bodied common carp belongs to the cyprinid family—the largest family of freshwater fish, with over 2,000 species found in temperate America and across the Old World. This fish feeds on a wide range of invertebrates and pond plants using its protrusible mouth. The common carp has been introduced to many parts of the world as a source of food—in places, it has become destructively invasive.

Northern pike

Esox lucius

- ↔ Up to 4 ft (1.2 m)
- 📍 North America, Europe, Asia
- ⊗ Common

No more than half a dozen species of pike live in cool weed-choked fresh waters around the northern hemisphere. All are elongated, big-mouthed predators of other fish that rely on ambushing prey from the cover of water plants. They have a distinct shovel-like snout and sharp teeth. The northern pike is the most widespread species—and the only one found in both North America and Eurasia.

Sockeye salmon

Oncorhynchus nerka

- ↔ Up to 33 in (84 cm)
- 📍 NE. Asia, North Pacific, NW. and W. North America
- ⊗ Common

Salmonids, including salmon, trout, and chars, are cold-water fish of the northern hemisphere. Many live in fresh waters, while others spend their adult lives at sea, but return upriver to breed at sites where they hatched. Sockeye salmon migrate from the Pacific Ocean into North American rivers and lakes, flushing red when breeding.

Prickly lanternfish

Myctophum asperum

- ↔ Up to 4 in (10 cm)
- 📍 North and South Pacific, W. and E. Atlantic, Indian Ocean
- ⊗ Not known

The skin of lanternfish carries light-producing organs, called photophores, which help them to communicate in the dark deep-water environment. This species migrates closer to the surface at night to feed on tiny planktonic crustaceans. During the day, they descend to depths of more than 2,450 ft (750 m).

Atlantic cod

Gadus morhua

- ↔ Up to 5 ft (1.5 m)
- 📍 North Atlantic, Arctic Ocean
- ⊗ Vulnerable

This large, schooling, predatory fish with a huge head and overhanging upper jaw can live for more than 60 years. However, overfishing has reduced the average age and size of populations. Atlantic cod live in the water over the continental shelf and usually feed at 100–250 ft (30–80 m) above areas of flat mud or sand.



They spawn in schools in established breeding grounds, with each female releasing millions of eggs. The larvae spend time in the ocean's plankton, taking up to seven years to reach their adult forms.

Angler

Lophius piscatorius

- ↔ Up to 7 ft (2 m)
- 📍 E. North Atlantic, Mediterranean, Black Sea
- ⊗ Not known

Anglerfish are so-called because their first dorsal fin spine is modified to form a line-and-bait structure for attracting prey. Many are found in deep water, but members of the monkfish family—including this European species—occupy the continental slope. They hunt on the seabed, using massive jaws equipped with hard backward-pointing teeth for grabbing large prey. They have even been known to lunge at diving birds.



Tropical two-wing flying fish

Exocoetetus volitans

- ↔ Up to 12 in (30 cm)
- 📍 Tropical and subtropical waters worldwide
- ⊗ Not known

Despite its name, this species does not actually fly; instead, this open-ocean fish uses its winglike pectoral fins to glide short distances across the water's surface—at full speed, it can glide for up to 12 seconds. This is used as an escape mechanism—the fish darts to the surface, where aerial launching is helped by a quivering tail that beats more than 50 times per second.